

News Weekly

Millions in Cuba without electricity after substation failure

Millions in Cuba faced a widespread blackout on Saturday due to a failure in the electric grid, marking the fourth outage in just six months amid an ongoing economic crisis. The Ministry of Energy attributed the blackout to an issue at a substation in Havana. As a result, internet and phone services were also disrupted, adding to the challenges faced by residents. President Miguel Díaz-Canel assured that authorities are actively working to restore power, with a focus on generating electricity for essential services like hospitals. The Cuban Electricity Union announced a strategy to develop interconnected "microsystems" to gradually restore power, and some of these systems are already operational in several provinces. The outage poses significant risks for food preservation, as many families rely heavily on electricity for cooking and refrigeration. (NBC News)



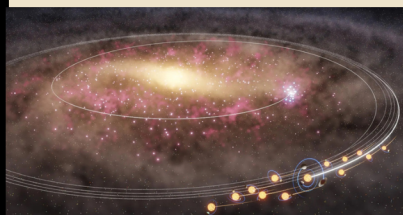
Yaks may hint at a way to treat brain diseases like MS

Scientists are exploring how genetics and environmental factors influence neurological resilience. Studies on yaks suggest specific genetic mutations may protect brain health in low-oxygen conditions, which could inform treatments for neurological disorders. Neuroscientist Liang Zhang found that yaks have normal white matter, essential for brain communication. His research showed that genetically modified mice with a specific mutation performed better in learning and memory tests when exposed to low oxygen. The Retsat gene aids myelin regeneration, which is crucial for nerve signal conduction. Injections of a related molecule minimized hypoxia's effects on myelin and improved MS-like symptoms in mice. However, experts warn that applying these findings to humans poses challenges, as current MS treatments focus on slowing progression rather than repairing damage. (Source: Science News)



Our Sun may have escaped the Milky Way's center with thousands of twin stars

The traditional narrative of our solar system's formation has been revised by new research from Tokyo Metropolitan University, suggesting a more dynamic origin. The study indicates that the Sun, believed to have formed 4.6 billion years ago in a dense stellar nursery near the Milky Way's center, migrated over 10,000 light-years to its current position. This movement was facilitated by gravitational interactions with the galaxy's spiral arms and central bar, allowing the Sun and its "twin" stars to escape a high-energy environment prone to supernovae. This migration to the "Galactic Habitable Zone" was crucial for Earth's stability and the evolution of life. The research reveals that the Sun is part of a larger group of stars with shared chemical properties, fundamentally altering our understanding of the solar system's history as a story of survival and relocation. (Source: Science Daily)



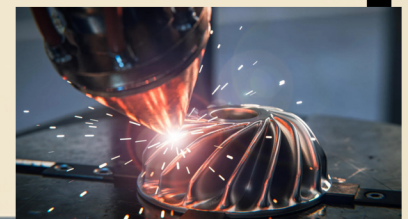
Hereditary peers to be removed from Lords as bill passes

Discussions about hereditary peers in the House of Lords have intensified, focusing on their role in the UK parliamentary system. Baroness Smith emphasized the need for reform, stating that sitting in Parliament shouldn't be based on inherited titles. The government plans to offer life peerages to Conservatives and crossbenchers, allowing some hereditary peers to remain. As a result, the Conservatives have withdrawn their opposition to the reform bill, which will see up to 92 hereditary peers depart when the current parliamentary session ends in May. Additionally, the government intends to increase the number of paid ministers in the Lords, addressing the issue of unpaid positions that have persisted for 25 years. (BBC News)



Scientists just found a way to 3D print one of the hardest metals on Earth

Tungsten carbide-cobalt (WC-Co) is widely valued for its extreme hardness, but that same strength also makes it very difficult to shape and manufacture. Current production methods consume large amounts of costly material while delivering relatively modest yields. As a result, researchers have been searching for a more efficient and economical way to produce these exceptionally tough materials. A new 3D-printing approach could transform how ultra-hard tungsten carbide tools are made. By softening metals with a hot-wire laser instead of melting them, researchers produced defect-free carbides while reducing costly material waste.



Paralympic Leaderboard Rankings

Rank	NPC	G	S	B	Total
1	CHN	15	13	16	44
2	USA	12	5	6	23
3	RUS	8	1	3	12
4	ITA	7	7	2	16
5	AUT	7	2	4	13
6	FRA	4	4	4	12
7	UKR	3	8	8	19

5	2		3		1
		1			
		2	1		6
	5	6	4		
	4			1	5
	1	5		3	4

Cheesy Chicken Enchiladas

This creamy chicken enchiladas recipe features tender shredded chicken, melty cheese in soft tortillas, and a rich white sauce. It includes a homemade enchilada sauce with cream cheese and diced green chilies for added flavor. Using rotisserie chicken simplifies the process, allowing for easy preparation of delicious Tex-Mex comfort food.



Ingredients for the dish:

- 2 pounds rotisserie chicken
- 2 cups shredded Mexican blend cheese
- 8 ounces cream cheese (preferred over sour cream)
- 2 tablespoons butter for sautéing
- 1 large onion and 3 cloves garlic for flavor
- 1 cup half-and-half for richness
- 1 cup chicken broth for moisture
- 4 ounces mild green chilies (2 cans)
- 2 teaspoons chili powder for seasoning
- 8-10 flour tortillas
- Fresh cilantro and scallions (1/4 cup each) for serving.

The Instructions

1. **Prep:** Preheat your oven to 375°F and grease a 9x13 baking dish.
2. **Mix Filling:** In a medium bowl, combine the shredded chicken with half of the shredded cheese (1.5 cups). Season with a little salt and pepper.
3. **Sauté:** In a large skillet, melt the butter over medium-high heat. Add the onion and sauté for 5–7 minutes until golden. Stir in the minced garlic for about 30 seconds.
4. **Make the Sauce:** Add the softened cream cheese, half-and-half, and chicken broth to the skillet. Whisk until the cream cheese is fully incorporated and the sauce is smooth. Stir in the green chilies and chili powder. Let it simmer for a few minutes until it lightly coats the back of a spoon.
5. **Assemble:** * Spoon a small amount of the sauce into the bottom of your baking dish.
 - Fill each tortilla with the chicken/cheese mixture, roll tightly, and place seam-side down in the dish.